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AP

■ People run in front of burned cars in the aftermath of an Israeli airstrike in the southern port city of Sidon, Lebanon, yesterday.

‘MIDEAST BULLY DEAD’: TRUMP SAYS IRAN WILL PAY THE PRICE

UAE slams attacks on Bahrain, Kuwait, Jordan

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump yesterday warned that Iran would “pay the price” for delaying negotiations, as fresh military exchanges between Washington and Tehran raised fears of a broader regional escalation.

Trump’s remarks came hours after US forces launched strikes on Iranian targets following the downing of an American attack helicopter.

In a post on his Truth Social platform, Trump declared: “The Bully of the Middle East is DEAD!!! They’ve taken too long to negotiate a deal that would have been great for them, now they will have to pay the price!!!”

Sharp shift

The comments marked a sharp shift in tone from the previous day, when Trump said negotiations to end the conflict were in their “final throes” and could be completed within “two or three days”.

The latest escalation began after US forces struck Iranian air-defence and radar facilities

UAE’S CONCERNS

The UAE joined Bahrain, Denmark, France, Germany, Greece, Latvia, the UK, the US and the EU in a joint press stakeout highlighting longstanding concerns over Iran’s nuclear programme and what they described as Tehran’s continued failure to meet its safeguards obligations and fully cooperate with the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA).

The UAE stressed the importance of resuming the committee’s work and called for the swift appointment of its chair and panel of experts to ensure effective oversight of sanctions implementation and address compliance issues.

—Gulf News Report

near the Strait of Hormuz. Iran responded by targeting US-linked facilities in the region.

Iran’s Revolutionary Guards said they launched missiles at four sites in Jordan. Jordan said it intercepted five missiles and reported no casualties.

Bahrain and Kuwait also reported Iranian attacks or hostile

aerial threats. The UAE strongly condemned the missile and drone attacks on Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan, describing them as violations of the countries’ sovereignty and threats to regional security and stability.

Full solidarity

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs reaffirmed the UAE’s full solidarity with the three nations and its support for all measures aimed at preserving their security and stability.

Separately, maritime security concerns persisted as private security guards aboard a cargo ship exchanged small-arms fire with gunmen in a small boat in the Gulf of Aden off Yemen’s coast, underscoring the widening instability across the region. The incident is the latest security incident along a vital shipping route plagued by threats from Yemen’s Al Houthi militants.

UN Secretary-General António Guterres warned of the risk of a return to “full war” in the Middle East, while the UN nuclear watchdog’s governing board approved a Western-backed resolution demanding that Iran provide information on its uranium stockpile and production facilities without delay.

SEE ALSO P7, 8, 11

Modi India’s longest-serving PM

With 4,399 days in office, he surpasses Jawaharlal Nehru’s record

DUBAI

BY ALEX ABRAHAM

Senior Associate Editor

Prime Minister Narendra Modi yesterday became India’s longest-serving democratically elected Prime Minister, surpassing a record held by Jawaharlal Nehru for more than six decades and marking another milestone in a political career that has reshaped the country’s electoral landscape.

With 4,399 consecutive days in office,



Modi moved past Nehru’s post-election tenure of 4,398 days. The milestone comes as the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government completes 12 years in power and enters the third year of its current term.

The achievement was marked by congratulatory messages from political leaders and world figures, including Italian Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni who tweeted: “Congratulations to @narendramodi who today becomes the longest-serving Prime Minister in the history of India.”

Longevity Authority launched in Dubai

Emirate to compete globally in quality of life and healthy longevity

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR

Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has directed the establishment of the Dubai Longevity Authority (DLA), a new body aimed at accelerating the emirate’s ambitions to become a global hub for life sciences, biotechnology and medical innovation.

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence, and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai will serve as President of DLA, while Helal Saeed Almarri, Director General of the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism (DET), has been appointed as its Chairman.

Sheikh Mohammed said the world is witnessing a rapid scientific revolution in life sciences, biotechnology and medical innovation, and that Dubai’s

ambition is to be at the heart of this global revolution and a centre for developing solutions that advance human health and quality of life.

Cutting-edge innovation

Leveraging cutting-edge innovation, robust governance, and strategic partnerships, the establishment of DLA will support the Dubai Economic Agenda, D33, and the Dubai Social Agenda 33, which aim, respectively, to position Dubai among the top three cities globally for quality of life and achieve a leading position in healthy life expectancy.

The new authority will work to accelerate the development of a world-class ecosystem that embraces advanced medical solutions, biotechnology and life sciences while integrating scientific research, innovation, investment and global partnerships to shape the future of health care.

“The body will lead a new phase in Dubai’s journey in one of the fastest-growing sectors of the global economy,” Sheikh Mohammed said.

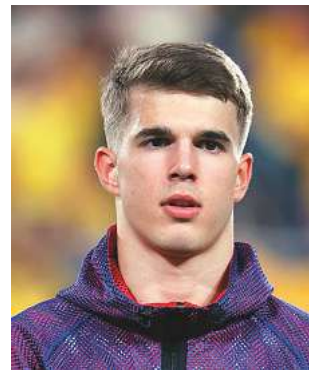
“As we have competed globally in economy, tourism and technology, we will also compete globally in quality of life and healthy longevity,” Sheikh Mohammed added.

NATION

Spotting heat exhaustion before it becomes heatstroke | P2

FIFA WORLD CUP 2026

Meet 10 rising stars ready to set the showpiece alight | P15



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